

RBI SURPLUS DECLINES

The surplus that the RBI transferred to the central government declined sharply to an eight-year low of ₹30,307 crore in FY22 due to a manifold rise in expenditure. The figure stood at ₹99,122 crore in FY21 and ₹57,127.53 crore in FY20. The central bank's total outlay jumped 280 per cent to ₹1.3 lakh crore. At the same time, its balance sheet size increased by ₹4.82 lakh crore to ₹61.90 lakh crore in FY22.

—RAHUL OBEROI



PHOTO BY ANI

RAINS MAY COOL INFLATION

With the monsoon clouds entering southern states days ahead of schedule, consumer goods manufacturers expect a good harvest, which may help douse the fire in the commodities market. Further, Indonesia lifting the temporary ban on crude edible oil exports may bring down costs for a range of daily essentials—soaps, biscuits, cosmetics, etc. Experts say these factors together may help reduce inflationary pressures by end-2022.

—ARNAB DUTTA

LANGUAGE NO BAR ANY MORE

Cross-language consumption of content is exploding in India, according to a study by consultancy firm Ormax Media. The study says the Indian SVOD audience (of which there are 109 million) watches content in 4.6 languages on average. And the audience for South Indian languages is expanding beyond their states. For example, 88 per cent Malayalam content viewers are from outside Kerala. The number is 82 per cent for Tamil vis-à-vis Tamil Nadu. Clearly, this opens up immense opportunities for streamers in India.

—VIDYA S.



PER CENT OF GROSS NATIONAL DISPOSABLE INCOME WAS THE FINANCIAL SAVING OF THE HOUSEHOLD SECTOR IN FY21, THE HIGHEST IN OVER TWO DECADES

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Third-party Vehicle Insurance Costs Rise

THE CENTRAL GOVERNMENT has notified new base rates for third-party vehicle insurance, effective from June 1, 2022. The new rates for motor vehicle insurance were last revised in FY20. In India, it is compulsory to buy insurance that provides coverage against third-party liabilities. According to the revised rates, private cars with 1,000 cubic capacity (cc) now have a premium of ₹2,094 as compared to ₹2,072 in FY20. Similarly, private cars with 1,000-1,500 cc will have premium rates of ₹3,416 compared to ₹3,221 earlier.

—TEENA JAIN KAUSHAL

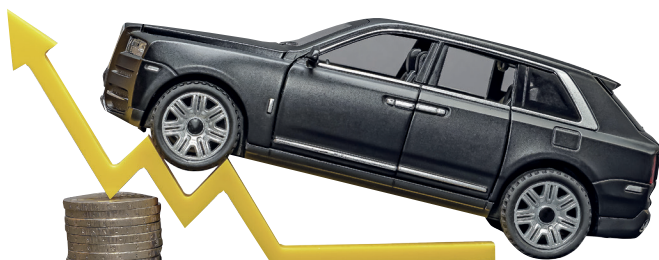


PHOTO BY MANEESH AGNIHOTRI



POWER CRISIS DEEPENS

As per an internal power ministry presentation seen by Reuters, India's coal supply is expected to be 154.7 million tonnes in Q2FY23, which is 42.5 million tonnes short of the projected requirement of 197.3 million tonnes. This comes at a time when the country is already grappling with power shortages following unprecedented levels of heat in April-May.

—RAJAT MISHRA